CREATIVE DIRECTION / EDITION 01

The city has a hold on you.

A fan campaign built around curiosity, character and the pleasure of finding your own way into Deadlock.

THE CITY HAS A HOLD ON YOU. / NON-VIDEO CAMPAIGN

CREATIVE PROPOSAL · PUBLICATION-READY EDITORIAL SYSTEM

01 / The idea

A place can catch your eye. A character can become your favorite. A moment with a team can bring you back. This campaign gives each of those attractions a clear, memorable place.

THE CITY HAS A HOLD ON YOU. is original fan campaign language. It treats the city as the connective tissue between atmosphere, heroes and player stories. It is not presented as canonical dialogue or Valve's official tagline.

PILLAR 01

THE CITY CALLS

Make architecture, strange details and the game's visual identity worth noticing. Let the first image invite a closer look.

Lead assets: master key visual, city study, wallpapers.

PILLAR 02

FIND YOUR CHARACTER

Give three heroes distinct editorial personalities. Lead with a readable silhouette and one strong thought.

Lead assets: Infernus, Dynamo and Ivy spotlights.

PILLAR 03

SHARE THE MOMENT

Help newcomers notice movement, timing and teamwork. Invite existing players to contribute a moment of their own.

Lead assets: gameplay primer, screenshot challenge, community selection.

02 / Who it is for

AUDIENCE	QUESTION TO ANSWER	CREATIVE RESPONSE
Curious PC players	What makes this world interesting?	A distinctive city image, a concise introduction and an official information link.
Players who enjoy hero-led competition	Who would I want to learn?	Three focused character spotlights with plain-language descriptions.
Existing Deadlock players	What can I add to this?	A screenshot prompt, useful discussion and clear credit for contributions.
Creators and community editors	Can I explain and credit this accurately?	A factsheet, source register and consistent asset labels.

03 / Message hierarchy

1. **Campaign thought:** The city has a hold on you.
2. **Supporting invitation:** Find the character. Read the moment. See the city differently.
3. **Useful context:** This collection explores Deadlock through original fan art direction, hero spotlights and player stories.
4. **Action:** Explore the collection, share a favorite detail, or consult the official Steam page for game information.

CURRENT GAME-STATUS LINE

Deadlock remains in early development. Access is limited to invitations from existing playtesters, and its release date is unannounced.

Official source: Deadlock on Steam. Checked 29 October 2026. Recheck before a public release of these materials.

04 / The visual voice

Use an editorial print language: strong typography, generous margins, fine rules, restrained texture and a clear focal subject. Images should feel selected and composed. Informational pieces should have the clarity of a field guide.

ELEMENT	SPECIFICATION	PURPOSE
Near-black	`#101c1d`	Primary canvas, heavy type and deep structure.
Ivory	`#eee6d0`	Reading surfaces, quiet contrast and print warmth.
Poison green	`#c5dc83`	Small signals, section markers and a controlled point of energy.
Typography	Expressive display serif; compact sans-serif metadata	Atmosphere in the headline; precision in the supporting text.
Composition	One primary subject; one headline; one deliberate action	Maintain recognition at both poster and phone size.
Image integrity	Retain identity, proportions and source context	Keep an official reference recognizable; label original interpretation.

05 / Asset architecture

The following IDs are stable editorial references shared by the copy deck and calendar. Export filenames may differ; retain these IDs in the delivery manifest.

ASSET ID	PIECE	JOB
KV-01	Master key visual	Introduce the campaign thought and visual identity.
HERO-01 / 02 / 03	Infernus / Dynamo / Ivy	Give each character a distinct, memorable spotlight.
PLAY-01	Five-panel gameplay primer	Offer an accessible way to read the action, with sources.
CITY-01	City study	Direct attention to environment, scale and atmosphere.
COMMUNITY-01	Streetlight Stories prompt	Explain a real participation format in one image.
WALL-01	Desktop and mobile wallpaper	Provide a useful, lasting expression of the campaign.
INFO-01	Factsheet / FAQ	Keep factual answers and official access information easy to find.
WEB-01	Campaign collection page	Connect visual discovery, useful information and official links.
KIT-01	Creator package	Make coverage and attribution straightforward.

06 / Hero language

INFERNUS

Heat finds a way.

A fast, fiery presence. The spotlight emphasizes momentum and flame without making claims about balance or an ideal build.

The Deadlock Wiki: Infernus. Community reference.

DYNAMO

Make space. Change the fight.

An image built around gravity, timing and the importance of being there for a team.

The Deadlock Wiki: Dynamo. Community reference.

IVY

Someone has your back.

A character-led invitation to think about support and connection.

The Deadlock Wiki: Ivy. Community reference.

All three headlines are original fan copy. The imagery must not imply that these are official class names, ability descriptions or quotes.

07 / What success means

Judge the work by understanding and participation. A viewer should identify the game, remember one distinct visual or character, and know where to find reliable information. An existing player should have a clear, low-friction way to join the conversation.

- **Creative recognition:** show a piece briefly and ask what the viewer remembers.
- **Useful attention:** compare saves, shares and meaningful replies per impression.
- **Action:** track clicks from the campaign's own page to the official information source.
- **Participation:** count eligible screenshot submissions, distinct contributors and permissioned selections.
- **Accuracy:** keep the source register current and log any factual correction.

Measurement boundary: Steamworks UTM Analytics requires product-specific reporting permissions. This project does not claim access to Valve's conversion data.

08 / Final review

- □ Every public-facing sentence is in English.
- □ Hero names, visual identities and source labels match.
- □ Headlines remain legible on a phone and in a small thumbnail.
- □ The unofficial identity is visible without overwhelming the artwork.
- □ Official facts link to an appropriate source; fan interpretation is identified.
- □ Game screenshots and original concept imagery are clearly distinguished.
- □ Every piece has a job in the rollout and a suitable destination.
- □ No release date, review quote, access guarantee or prize has been invented.
- □ Links, text wrapping, image crops and print pages have been checked.

Campaign process references: Steamworks marketing practices and GameMaker's marketing guide. Their principles inform this proposal; its creative choices are independent.